GOOGLE MAPS PRD

A Product Requirements Document (PRD) proposing an improvement to Google Maps that makes it easier for users to organize saved places and turn them into actionable trip plans.

PROJECT OVERVIEW

Product: Google Maps
Project Type: Product Requirements Document (PRD)
Project Focus: Saved Places & Trip Planning
Role: Product Management
Status: Portfolio Project
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Project Summary

Google Maps helps users discover locations, navigate to destinations, save places, and plan routes. However, users who save multiple places for a trip may still need to manually organize those locations into a practical itinerary.

This project proposes a Trip Planner feature that allows users to group saved locations into a trip, organize them by day, arrange their visit order, and receive route and timing recommendations.

The goal is to reduce the effort required to move from "places I want to visit" to "my trip is planned."

PROBLEM STATEMENT

Users often save multiple places they want to visit but may struggle to organize those places into an efficient trip.

For example, someone planning a weekend trip might save:

Restaurants
Hotels
Tourist attractions
Shopping locations
Events
Other places of interest

The user then has to manually determine:

Which places should be visited together
What order to visit them in
How much time to spend at each location
How long transportation between locations will take
Which places should be visited on different days
This creates additional planning work outside the core Google Maps experience.
Problem

How might Google Maps help users transform their saved places into an organized and practical trip plan with less manual planning?

Product Goal

Create a simple trip-planning experience inside Google Maps that allows users to organize saved locations into a structured itinerary and navigate between them efficiently.

PRIMARY GOAL
Reduce the effort required to plan a multi-location trip.

SECONDARY GOALS
Increase engagement with saved places.
Encourage users to use Google Maps before and during trips.

Make saved places more actionable.
Help users discover efficient routes between multiple destinations.

Improve the overall trip-planning experience.

TARGET USERS

PRIMARY USERS
People planning trips who have saved multiple locations in Google Maps.
Example User Segments

Tourists
Users visiting a city and wanting to organize attractions, restaurants, and activities.

Weekend Travelers
Users planning short trips and wanting to maximize their available time.

Business Travelers
Users visiting multiple locations and needing an efficient route.

Local Explorers
Users who save restaurants, events, attractions, and other places they want to visit later.

USER PERSONA

Persona: Mahanah
Age: 28
Occupation: Fashion Designer/Public Servant
Location: Akwa Ibom, Nigeria

Background

Mahanah is planning a three day trip to another city. She uses Google Maps to discover restaurants, tourist attractions, and places to visit.

She saves interesting locations as she discovers them but later finds it difficult to organize them into a realistic schedule.

Goals

· Visit several places during the trip.
· Avoid unnecessary travel.
· Save planning time.
· Have a clear itinerary.
· Easily navigate between locations.

Pain Points
· Too many saved locations.
· Difficulty deciding what to visit first.
· Manually calculating travel time.
· Switching between different apps for planning.
· Difficulty turning saved places into an itinerary.

User Story

Primary User Story

As a traveler, I want to organize my saved Google Maps locations into a trip itinerary so that I can plan my activities and navigate between them efficiently.

Supporting User Stories

As a user, I want to group saved places into a trip so that I can keep trip-related locations together.

As a user, I want to assign places to specific days so that I can organize my schedule.

As a user, I want to rearrange destinations so that I can decide the order in which I visit them.

As a user, I want to see estimated travel time between destinations so that I can create a realistic itinerary.

As a user, I want Google Maps to suggest an efficient order for my destinations so that I spend less time traveling.

PROPOSED SOLUTION

Trip Planner:
Introduce a Trip Planner experience within Google Maps.
Users can select saved locations and add them to a trip.

They can then:
1. Create a trip.
2. Add saved locations.
3. Organize locations by day.
4. Reorder destinations.
5. View estimated travel times.
6. Receive route suggestions.
7. Navigate directly from the itinerary.

Example
A user creates:

Trip: 3 Days in Abuja

Day 1
· National Mosque
· Millennium Park
· Local Restaurant

Day 2
· Aso Rock
· Arts & Crafts Village
· Restaurant

Day 3
· Shopping Mall
· Airport

Google Maps displays the planned locations and estimated travel time between each destination.

MVP Scope

The MVP will focus on the simplest functionality required to validate whether users find an integrated trip-planning experience useful.

MVP Features

Create a Trip:
Users can create a new trip and give it a name.

Example:

"Abuja Weekend Trip"

Add Saved Places:
Users can select locations from their saved places and add them to the trip.

Organize by Day:
Users can assign destinations to different days.

Example:

Day 1
· Location A
· Location B

Day 2
· Location C
· Location D

Reorder Destinations:
Users can manually change the order of destinations.

Travel Time Estimates:
Google Maps displays estimated travel time between destinations.

Example:
Location A & Location B
18 min drive

Route Suggestion:
The product suggests an efficient order for visiting destinations based on available routing information.
Users can accept the suggested order or manually rearrange locations.

Start Navigation:
Users can start navigation directly from the itinerary.

Out of Scope for MVP
The following features are intentionally excluded from the initial version:

· Hotel booking
· Flight booking
· Restaurant reservations
· Payment functionality
· Travel insurance
· Full AI-generated travel itineraries
· Social trip planning
· Public itinerary sharing
· Travel budgeting
· Automatic attraction recommendations
· Offline itinerary generation

These features may be considered in future versions.

Functional Requirements

FR1 — Create Trip
The system must allow users to create a new trip.

Requirements
· User selects "Create Trip."
· User enters a trip name.
· User optionally selects trip dates.
· The system creates the trip.

Acceptance Criteria
· Users can successfully create a trip.
· Trip appears in the user's trip list.
· Trip can be edited or deleted.

FR2 — Add Saved Places
The system must allow users to add saved locations to a trip.

Acceptance Criteria
· Users can view saved places.
· Users can select one or multiple places.
· Selected places appear on the trip.
· A location cannot accidentally be added multiple times.

FR3 — Assign Places to Days
Users must be able to assign destinations to specific trip days.

Acceptance Criteria
· Users can select a trip day.
· Users can move a location between days.
· Locations remain associated with the selected trip.

FR4 — Reorder Locations
Users must be able to change the order of destinations.

Acceptance Criteria
· Users can drag or otherwise reorder locations.
· The updated order is saved.
· Route information updates when appropriate.
·
FR5 — Display Travel Time
The system should display estimated travel time between consecutive destinations.

Acceptance Criteria
· Travel time appears between relevant destinations.
· Travel time updates when destinations are reordered.
· The information uses available Google Maps routing data.

FR6 — Route Optimization
The system should provide an optional suggested destination order.

Acceptance Criteria
· Users can request an optimized order.
· The system provides a suggested sequence.
· Users can accept or reject the suggestion.
· User retains control over the final itinerary.
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FR7 — Navigation
Users must be able to start navigation from the itinerary.

Acceptance Criteria
· User selects a destination.
· Google Maps opens navigation.
· Navigation uses the selected destination.

User Flow:

Open Google Maps
Open Saved Places
Select "Create Trip"
Name Trip
Add Saved Locations
Assign Locations to Days
Arrange Destination Order
View Travel Times
Optimize Route (Optional)

Review Itinerary
Start Navigation

UX REQUIREMENTS

The experience should be:

Simple
Users should be able to create a basic itinerary without needing instructions.

Fast
Adding a saved location should require minimal steps.

Flexible
Users should be able to manually modify Google's recommendations.

Transparent
Users should understand why a suggested route or order is being recommended.

Mobile-Friendly
The feature should work effectively on mobile devices because Google Maps is frequently used while traveling.

EDGE CASES

Edge Case 1 — Location Closed:
If a location is permanently closed or temporarily unavailable, Google Maps should notify the user.

Edge Case 2 — Duplicate Location:
If the user attempts to add the same location twice, the system should prevent accidental duplication or clearly indicate the duplicate.

Edge Case 3 — Long Travel Distance:
If destinations are extremely far apart, the system should warn the user that the itinerary may require significant travel time.

Edge Case 4 — Insufficient Time:
If the planned destinations and estimated travel times exceed the available time for a day, the system could display a warning.

Edge Case 5 — Destination Becomes Unavailable:
If a saved place changes its operating hours or closes, the itinerary should reflect the updated information where available.

Edge Case 6 — Poor Connectivity:
Users should still be able to access previously saved itinerary information where Google Maps' existing offline capabilities permit.

Non-Functional Requirements

Performance
Trip information should load quickly under normal network conditions.

Reliability
User-created trips should be saved reliably and synchronized across supported devices.

Privacy
Trip information and saved locations should follow Google's existing privacy and account controls.

Accessibility
The feature should support accessible navigation, readable text, appropriate contrast, and screen-reader compatibility.

Scalability
The feature should support users with different numbers of destinations without becoming difficult to use.

SUCCESS METRICS

The MVP should be evaluated using measurable product metrics.

Primary Metric
Trip Creation & Completion Rate
Percentage of users who create a trip and successfully organize at least one itinerary.

Secondary Metrics
Trip Creation Rate
Number of users creating at least one trip.

Saved Place & Trip Conversion
Percentage of saved places that are subsequently added to a trip.

Itinerary Completion
Percentage of created trips where users organize destinations across one or more days.

Navigation Usage
Percentage of trip users who start navigation from their itinerary.

Repeat Usage
Percentage of users who create another trip within a defined period.

Feature Retention
Percentage of users who return to the Trip Planner after their first use.

North Star Metric
Successful Trip Plans Created

The number of trips where a user:
1. Create a trip.
2. Adds at least two destinations.
3. Organize the destinations.
4. Views the itinerary.

This metric focuses on whether users successfully complete the core job the feature is designed to support.

HYPOTHESES

Hypothesis 1
If users can convert saved places into organized trips, they will spend less effort manually planning their trips.

Hypothesis 2
If Google Maps provides travel-time information between destinations, users will create more realistic itineraries.

Hypothesis 3
If Google Maps provides optional route optimization, users will be more likely to complete multi-location trips.

Hypothesis 4
If trip planning is integrated into Google Maps, users will have less need to use separate planning tools.

User Research Plan

Before full development, research should be conducted to validate the problem.

Research Questions

1. How do users currently plan multi-location trips?
2. Do users save places before traveling?
3. What happens after users save multiple locations?
4. What makes itinerary planning difficult?
5. Do users currently use separate travel-planning applications?
6. How important is travel time when planning a trip?
7. Would users trust an automatically suggested route?
8. How much control would users want over route recommendations?
9. What information is most important when planning a day?
10. Would users use a trip-planning feature inside Google Maps?

USER RESEARCH METHOD

Proposed Research
User Interviews
Interview 5–10 people who have recently planned a multi-location trip.

Survey
Conduct a short survey to identify common planning behaviors and pain points.

Usability Testing
Create a simple prototype and ask users to:
Create a three-day trip using five saved locations.

Measure:
· Completion rate
· Time taken
· Number of errors
· Points of confusion
· User feedback

Competitive Considerations

Potential alternatives include:
· Apple Maps
· Waze
· Trip planning applications
· Google Search
· Notes applications
· Spreadsheets
· Travel blogs and websites

The objective is not necessarily to replace every travel planning tool but to make Google Maps more useful for users who already depend on it for location discovery and navigation.

RISKS

Risk 1 — Feature Complexity
Adding too many planning capabilities could make Google Maps more complicated.

Mitigation: Keep the MVP focused on saved places, organization, routing, and navigation.

Risk 2 — Poor Route Recommendations
Suggested routes may not always match user preferences.

Mitigation: Make optimization optional and allow users to manually control the itinerary.

Risk 3 — Low Adoption
Users may continue using existing travel-planning tools.

Mitigation: Test the feature with users who already save multiple locations.

Risk 4 — Information Overload
Showing too much information could make the itinerary difficult to understand.

Mitigation: Prioritize destinations, dates, travel time, and navigation.

MVP PRIORITIZATION

Feature| Priority| Reason
Create Trip| P0| Core functionality
Add Saved Places| P0| Required for trip creation
Organize by Day| P0| Core planning experience
Reorder Destinations| P0| Gives users control
Travel Time| P0| Helps users create realistic plans
Start Navigation| P0| Connects planning to Google Maps' core functionality
Route Optimization| P1| Valuable but not required for initial validation
Trip Sharing| P2| Useful future enhancement
AI Itinerary Generation| P2| Requires additional validation
Travel Budgeting| P3| Outside MVP problem

PRODUCT ROLLOUT

Phase 1 — Internal Testing

Test the feature internally to identify major usability and technical issues.

Phase 2 — Small Beta
Release the feature to a limited group of users.

Measure:
· Trip creation
· Feature usage
· Itinerary completion
· Navigation usage
· User feedback

Phase 3 — Iteration
Analyze user behavior and feedback.

Improve:
· Trip creation
· Destination organization
· Route recommendations
· User interface

Phase 4 — Wider Release
Expand availability after the MVP demonstrates sufficient usability and engagement.

FUTURE OPPORTUNITIES

If the MVP demonstrates strong user demand, potential future features could include:

AI Trip Suggestions:
Generate an itinerary based on user preferences.

Collaborative Trips:
Allow multiple people to contribute destinations to the same trip.

Shared Itineraries:
Allow users to share completed itineraries with friends.

Restaurant & Activity Recommendations:
Recommend nearby activities based on the user's itinerary.

Budget Planning:
Estimate transportation and activity costs.

Smart Rescheduling:
Automatically suggest itinerary changes when delays or closures occur.

Personalized Recommendations:
Use user preferences and previous activity to improve suggestions.

PRODUCT DECISIONS

Decision 1

The MVP will focus on organization and navigation, rather than attempting to become a complete travel-booking platform.

Decision 2
Route optimization will be optional rather than automatically overriding the user's preferred order.

Decision 3
Users will maintain control over their itinerary.

Decision 4
The first version will prioritize users who already save multiple locations because this provides a clear entry point into the feature.

OPEN QUESTIONS

Before development, the product team should validate:

1. How many saved locations should a trip support?
2. Should users be able to add places directly from search?
3. Should trip dates be mandatory?
4. Should Google automatically assign destinations to days?
5. How should the product handle different transportation modes?
6. Should users be able to optimize based on distance, time, or personal preference?
7. Should trips be shareable in the MVP?
8. Should users be able to collaborate on trips?
9. How should the feature work when connectivity is limited?
10. Which users should be included in the initial beta?

DEFINITION OF DONE

The MVP is considered ready when:
Users can create a trip.
Users can name a trip.
Users can add saved locations.
Users can assign locations to different days.
Users can reorder destinations.
Travel time is displayed between relevant destinations.
Users can request route optimization.
Users can manually override the suggested order.
Users can start navigation.
Trip data is saved reliably.
Basic usability testing has been completed.
Major usability issues identified during testing have been addressed.

Expected User Value
The proposed feature should help users move from:

"I saved these places."

to:

"I know where I'm going, when I'm going, and how to get there."
The product's core value proposition is to reduce the planning effort required to turn saved locations into a practical itinerary.

PORTFOLIO REFLECTION

What I Practiced
This project demonstrates my ability to:
· Identify a user problem.
· Define a target user.
· Create user personas.
· Develop user stories.
· Define an MVP.
· Write functional requirements.
· Define acceptance criteria.
· Prioritize features.
· Develop product hypotheses.
· Define product metrics.
· Identify risks.
· Think through edge cases.
· Create a product rollout plan.
· Translate a problem into a structured product solution.

Key Product Management Takeaway

A strong product solution does not need to solve every possible problem at once.

For this concept, the MVP focuses on a specific user problem:

Helping users organize saved locations into a practical trip plan.

Additional functionality can be tested and introduced based on user research and product data.

Tools:

Google Docs / Notion — PRD documentation
Figma — Optional wireframes
Google Forms — User research
Google Sheets — Research analysis
GitHub — Portfolio documentation

Disclaimer:

This is an independent Product Management portfolio project created for learning and demonstration purposes.
The proposed feature is not an official Google Maps feature and is not affiliated with or endorsed by Google.

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A Product Management professional with a background in product research, user research, market research, competitive analysis, content strategy, community management and digital operations.

This project was created as part of my Product Management portfolio to demonstrate practical product discovery, research and analytical skills.